



CARPENTER

JOB DESCRIPTION

A carpenter makes and installs the wooden elements of a building. These include its large structural pieces, such as the roof beams, floor supports, and wall partitions, as well as the internal fixtures, such as staircases, kitchen cabinets, doors, and baseboards. Carpenters follow drawings and blueprints, and ensure that their work meets safety and quality standards.



SALARY

Apprentice carpenter ★★★★★
Experienced carpenter ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Self-employment is common • Market dictated by the economic state of the construction industry • Many experienced carpenters take on contracting roles in construction

CAREER PATHS

There are many opportunities for carpenters in the construction industry. While working, you can study for further vocational qualifications if you wish to specialize in areas such as cabinet making or building conservation.

TRADE SCHOOL STUDENT

If you have an interest in carpentry, you can study for a certificate in carpentry or joinery in college to help you find employment. You can then study for higher diplomas if you wish to specialize.



APPRENTICE Some larger construction or kitchen fitting companies may employ you as an apprentice straight from high school, allowing you to learn on the job.



FURNITURE MAKER

Makes pieces of wooden furniture, such as chairs, tables, and cupboards. Some also carry out restoration work on antique items and properties.



CARPENTER You may focus on one area of construction, such as making the frames of buildings, but most carpenters provide a wide range of services to their clients.

